unprecedented opportunity to make the best of my two-year time in the finance ministry. I will always remain grateful to him. The arrival of Nirmala Sitharaman in the ministry created the right conditions for me to think of widening my sphere of work—from the government to society at large. The last two years, since October 2019 when I left the government after taking voluntary retirement, have been most satisfying, enriching and productive despite COVID-19 disruptions. I thank Nirmala Sitharaman for making me harness enough strength to break out from the gravitational pull of the government service.

I began writing blogs on economic, financial and fiscal matters after I left the government, which attracted the attention of a lot of people. I am deeply thankful to Penguin Random House India who agreed to publish a book authored by me. Manish from Penguin has been with me in this journey—from conceptualizing this book to now publishing it. I am thankful to Manish, Ralph and the team of editors and associates at Penguin for making this maiden venture of writing a book a great learning, enjoyable and rewarding experience.

Arati Menon, at my request, did the first editing of this book. She has the uncanny ability to reconstruct sentences, making these read well without any loss of content and meaning. I cannot thank her enough for making this long book an eminently readable book.

I want to thank you, the reader as well, for the time spent on going through this book or some parts of it. I hope this was worth your time.

Makar Sakranti, 14 January 2022
New Delhi

Subhash Chandra Garg